

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

31 August 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the paralegal role at the boutique litigation firm advertised through Ryder Reid Legal, as it directly matches the disputes experience I have built over the past two years and represents the natural next step toward a training contract.

At BCLP I spent six months in the International Arbitration team supporting a complex investment arbitration. In the months before a significant procedural deadline, I became the only junior on the matter, which meant coordinating documents, tracking outstanding actions, and helping to ensure submission was on time. Within that I reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial, amended sections of the memorial itself, and drafted procedural orders and procedural histories. A partner and associate told me my performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor. My second rotation in Real Estate Disputes involved preparing electronic hearing bundles, assisting with skeleton arguments, conducting legal research on rights of light, easements and leasehold issues, and managing large volumes of documents across several matters with competing deadlines. Both rotations gave me practical experience of the document review and bundle preparation that sit at the centre of this role.

Since then I have been advising clients at Citizens Advice East Berkshire on welfare, housing, employment and debt matters. Each matter runs from initial interview through to submission: I take factual statements, identify evidential gaps, draft correspondence, prepare document schedules and maintain case records to deadline. Working with vulnerable clients on time-sensitive issues has sharpened my judgement about how to communicate procedural requirements clearly and how to manage a file carefully when the stakes are high for the person on the other side of the table.

A firm focused on complex, high-value litigation is where I want to develop. The BCLP arbitration work showed me what it takes to support a serious piece of litigation under real pressure, and the Citizens Advice caseload has kept those skills current while adding client-facing responsibility. A role that offers hands-on involvement in disputes of that kind, working toward a training contract, is exactly the environment I am looking to join.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva